

Name: ____ Date: ____ Publishing track (circle one): LinkedIn / Portfolio Notes-Blog / Google Doc

1. What I was doing (1–2 sentences — the project, task, or situation):

1 / 3

Read your assembled draft and answer yes or no for each:

Check	Yes/No
Does my draft name at least one concrete, real detail (a tool, error, number, or decision) rather than a vague claim?	
Have I avoided words like "expert," "mastered," or "guru" for something I only just learned or did once?	
Would I be comfortable if someone asked me three follow-up questions about this and I could honestly answer them?	
Does my draft include all three formula parts (what I was doing / what I learned / why it helps others)?	
Is my draft roughly 100–250 words — not padded with filler, and not missing a part?	
Does my hook state something specific, not something generic like "I learned a lot this week"?	

If any answer is "No," revise that part of your draft before submitting.

Part 3: Filled Example — Jordan R.

- 1. What I was doing:** This week I built a simple to-do list app where you can add and check off tasks.
- 2. What I learned or noticed:** It worked great until I deleted every task and the app crashed with a blank error screen. I learned that I had only tested my app with tasks already in the list, so my code assumed there would always be at least one item. The fix was one `if` statement checking whether the list was empty before displaying it.
- 3. Why it might help someone else:** If you're building anything with a list — tasks, messages, search results — try emptying it out completely before you call it done.
- 4. Hook:** Testing your app's "empty state" actually matters.
- 5. Takeaway:** The "nothing here" case is easy to forget and easy to break — always test it.
- 6. Assembled draft:**

Testing your app's "empty state" actually matters

This week I built a simple to-do list app where you can add and check off tasks. It worked great — until I deleted every task and the app crashed with a blank error screen.

I learned that I had only tested my app with tasks already in the list, so I never noticed that my code assumed there would always be at least one item. The fix was one `if` statement checking whether the list was empty before trying to display it.

If you're building anything with a list — tasks, messages, search results — try emptying it out completely before you call it done. The "nothing here" case is easy to forget and easy to break.

Self-check for Jordan's draft: All six checks pass — concrete detail (the empty-list crash and the `if` statement fix), no inflated language, honest and answerable claims, all three formula parts present, appropriate length, and a

specific (not generic) hook.

Part 4: 5-Piece Content Tracker

Use this table to plan all five content pieces required for this course. Fill in topic ideas as you think of them across the next lessons — you don't need all five ideas today, but list at least one or two beyond piece #1 if you already have thoughts.

Piece #	Topic Idea	Status
1	<i>(today's draft — summarize your topic in a few words)</i>	Drafted
2		Not started
3		Not started
4		Not started
5		Not started

Example (Jordan R.'s tracker):

Piece #	Topic Idea	Status
1	Testing the "empty state" of a to-do list app	Drafted
2	A mini-tutorial on using <code>if</code> statements to catch edge cases	Idea only
3	Lesson from a group project about splitting up tasks	Idea only
4	Tip on naming variables clearly after a messy project	Not started
5	Reflection on my first time presenting a project to the class	Not started

Status options: **Not started / Idea only / Drafted / Reviewed / Published**